

Female Sex Worker Costing Study – 2019

Introduction and objectives of the project –

Female sex workers (FSWs) continue to have great risks of adverse sexual and reproductive health (SRH) outcomes compared to women in the general population.

They have higher risks of HIV, STIs, unintended pregnancies, gender violence and adverse birth outcomes. To mitigate the challenges faced by FSW, UNFPA through ICRH is supporting integrated and stigma-free SRH and HIV services in Kilifi and Mtwapa towns. However, as ICRH continue to scale up the services for FSW, information on the unit expenditure per FSW reached is lacking. The overall objective of this study was to estimate the unit expenditure for both FSW in Kilifi and Mtwapa Drop in-Centers (DIC).

The analysis was undertaken from a program perspective using step-down costing methods. The unit expenditure per person per year is the cost of providing one FSW with SRH and HIV services for a full 12 months.

Findings

The overall unit expenditure across the two sites is \$105.93 (Kshs 10,593) per person per year. The findings showed that the unit expenditure per FSW per year of SRH and HIV services was highest at the Kilifi DIC, with a unit cost of \$121.96 (Kshs 12,196) while the unit expenditure at the Mtwapa DICE was \$ 89.90 (Kshs 8,990) per person per year.

The unit expenditure per monthly visit is \$10.16 in Mtwapa and \$7.49 in the Kilifi DIC. The main cost driver in the FSW program in Mtwapa and Kilifi DICES was personnel costs which accounted for 59.7% and 54.6% of the total cost respectively.

Conclusion

This study provides the most complete evidence to date on the unit expenditure of FSW services in Mtwapa and Kilifi DICES. The considerable variation in unit expenditure suggests a potential area for improving efficiency. While this study has provided an important characterization of the costs of the FSW programs services, further research and analysis of these data is required to examine the determinants of costs, including whether the extent of integration has an impact on costs.